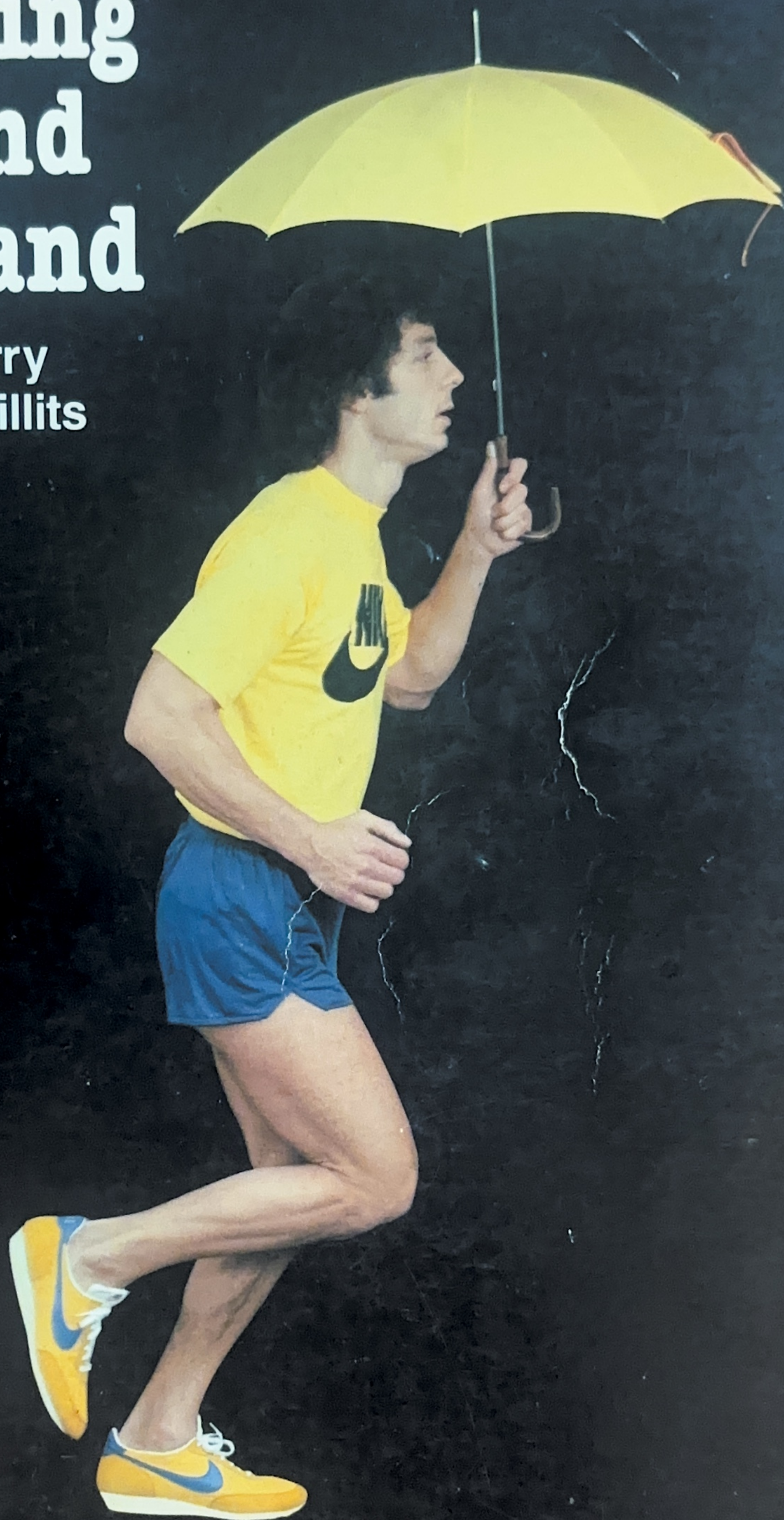


Running Around Portland

by John Perry
and Buzz Willits



A guide to the best running in the Portland, Vancouver area

1-92 P.P

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Graphics and Book Design by Peter Moore and Lolita Ceisi
Photography Ancil Nance
Typesetting Royal Typesetting
Printed by Artline Printing
Editing Caryl Waters
Color Separation by Wy East Color

Copyright © 1979 by RAP Press
Library of Congress Catalog Card Number 79-63570
Manufactured in U S A

First Edition
First Printing, March 1979

RAP Press
2655 N W Overton
Portland, Ore 97210

A guide to the best running in the Portland, Vancouver area

START



Foreward

All runners seem to have a common interest in two things: locating pleasant, traffic-free courses and knowing how far they have run. It is to these ends that we have written this book. We are currently inundated with an avalanche of books on how to run, how to train, how to eat for running, how to expand your consciousness through running, and so on. Most of these books are likely to be read once and relegated to the book shelf.

This book is meant to be used - carried in your car, bicycle pack, hand bag or athletic bag. It is a portable reference book of facts and information on the running/jogging scene in the greater Portland metropolitan area. Look at it as a connoisseur's tour guide to the finest running places in this area. In another sense, Running Around Portland can plainly save you time -- time you would spend hunting for new places to run other than your usual neighborhood routes. And no more guessing about the distance, or driving back and forth over the course with your inaccurate odometer. All you have to do is run -- we've done the rest.

We hope this book will encourage beginners to get out and experience the joys and benefits of running. We also want to show all runners some new places which will enhance their running experience and bring a greater appreciation of the fine running environment waiting for discovery in our own backyard. Contrary to the image of many non-runners, the Portland area is a fine year-round running locale. Temperatures are generally mild and going out in rain or darkness doesn't take much getting used to. The runs in this book are good year-round and offer a pleasant way to pursue this healthy and invigorating pastime.

Coverage

We have included a selection of the outstanding running and jogging routes within Multnomah, Clackamas, and Washington counties in Oregon and Clark County in Washington. Many of these runs are used in regularly-scheduled events while others are known only to a handful of recreational runners. Emphasis is on loop and circular routes.

How To Use This Book

We've spent a lot of time on the planning and organization of this book and urge you to take a few minutes and read this section carefully to insure getting maximum use of it.

Following this section is a two-page map of the four counties. It is divided into five areas which correspond to the five sections comprising the main body of the book: North Portland and Near East Side, Suburban East Side, Near West Side, Suburban West Side and Clark County. The runs are presented in numerical order. Use the front map to locate the area you want to run in, then peruse the narratives to find one you like.

With the exception of courses used in meets, every run was measured with the same type of bike-mounted device used to measure official AAU-sanctioned runs. You can depend on the accuracy of these distances to within a tenth of a mile. All measuring was done on the inside edge of the road.

Length of the run and total elevation gain (as opposed to highest elevation) were the primary criteria used in measuring "Difficulty." The beginning runner or jogger should feel comfortable with any run rated 1, 2, or 3. The average runner, who covers around 10-20 miles a week, should be able to enjoy the 4, 5, and 6-rated runs without strain. The highest rated runs, 7 through 10, should only be attempted by the stronger and more fit runner. Having explained this, we urge runners at either end of the spectrum not to feel limited in eventually trying all the runs.

In rating "aesthetics", we considered factors such as scenic views, interesting landscapes, historic sights, attractive neighborhoods and unique attractions, such as the little-known paved walking trail on the east side of the Willamette River in downtown Portland.

Our principal concern with "Bad Weather Running" was those dirt trails that turn to slippery muck in the rain. A low rating doesn't mean it's not runnable during winter, only that it's likely to be muddy or slippery. "Auto Traffic" speaks for itself. Volume and density of traffic (the primary concern of most runners) are included in this rating, along with other contributing factors such as width of roads, availability and condition of road shoulders and traffic lights. A low rating doesn't mean don't run it -- if that were the case, we wouldn't have included it. What it does mean is don't run it during rush hours.

Now take a look at one of the course maps. Most of the maps are oriented with north pointing up. In cases where altitude gain is an important factor we have included a profile, or graphic cross-cut of the run, showing altitude changes.

A particular mention should be made of the four-page fold-out map in the Near West Side section. We believe this map is unsurpassed for showing walking/jogging trails in the spectacular forested park system on Portland's west side. The map encompasses Hoyt Arboretum, Macleay and Forest Parks and includes the 16.7 mile length of the Wildwood Trail from its beginning at the Western Forestry Center near the Zoo to Saltzman Road. We give you five fine loops in this incredible park system (the largest urban wilderness within an American city) and leave it to you to use the map and do further exploration.

How To Use The Appendices

The Appendices includes information and data which should be of value whether you're a beginning jogger or veteran runner. First is a listing of key running resources in this area. These are non-profit organizations and publications which can assist you with specific services or provide information related to running.

Next is a calendar of annual running events in the greater Portland area which are not track meets and are more than a mile in length. Only annually scheduled runs are included. Remember that specific dates of events change every year. We have included a few runs outside the metro area which are of special interest to local runners (such as the Seaside Run in August) and all marathons in the state (five as of this printing).

Because we feel strongly about the positive physiological benefits of running, we are including charts developed by Dr. Kenneth Cooper and his staff at the Institute for Aerobics Research giving the aerobic points for all the runs in this book. The aerobics systems (based on the body's ability to process oxygen within a given time period) is an effective and scientifically sound method for measuring the value of your training.

Dr. Cooper's system awards aerobic points for various levels of activity in a number of sports. He recommends attaining a minimum of 30 points a week for maintenance of optimum health. Using the charts you

can accurately log your daily and weekly physical fitness progress. Under the appropriate distance, find where your time falls in the first two columns and the third column will give you the aerobic points for that run. For a more complete listing, see the appendix of Dr. Cooper's new book, The New Aerobics, available in paperback.

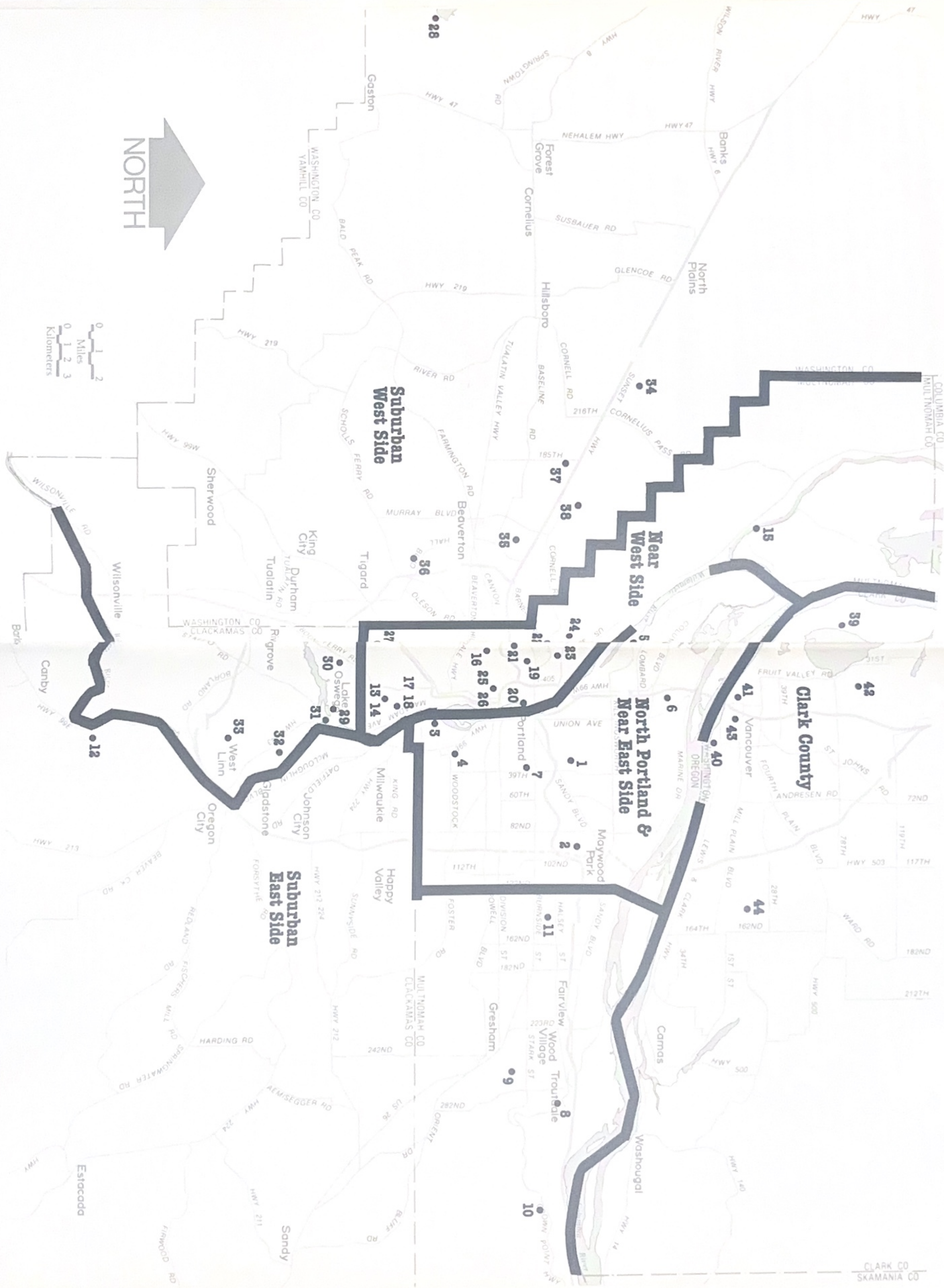
Nearly all runners are acutely conscious of their physical health. Of special interest to beginners is the Calorie Table which can give you an idea how many calories you've expended for the distance you ran.

Good Running!

Acknowledgements

From the very beginning, the development of this book has benefited from the generous support and encouragement of people within the local running community. People have shared their favorite runs, offered advice, shared information and ideas. We are particularly grateful to the following: Ken Wiedkamp, Felicia Gniewosz, and Leo Sherry of the Oregon Road Runners Club; Bob Moser and Lance Thiele of the Clark County Track Club; Phil Pennington of the YMCA Metropolitan Fitness Center's Running Committee; Wally Larsen of Clossco/Adidas Promotions/Pacific Northwest; Val Vitums of the Portland Community College P.E. Department; Tony Evans of the Lewis and Clark College Health and Physical Education Department; Lee Cave, Track Coach of Columbia River High School in Vancouver; local media personality Joe Loprinzi, Director of Body Building and Running Programs at the Multnomah Athletic Club; and Mike Johnson, Track Coach at the University of Portland.

Very special thanks go to Nelson Farris and the other people at Nike/Blue Ribbon Sports in Beaverton who supported this project from the very start. Their enthusiasm and help made this book possible.



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North Portland & Neat East Side



1

This is a honey of an east tour, linking together some older residential areas, three parks, a golf course and spectacular views of the city plus the only extinct volcano (Mt. Tabor) located within a city in North America.

The run begins at Grant Park, long a mecca to runners on the east side of the city. Grant Park is located on NE 33rd Ave. just a few blocks north of Broadway. If you're coming from the west side, take I-80 and use the 33rd Ave. exit. Turn right on 33rd, cross Broadway and look for the park on your right.

Start the run by circling the high school along the grass. Pass the front of the school and continue north on 36th Avenue. About half-way up the hill a jog to the left, then to the right will put you on Alameda. Follow the map through the golf course, and across the freeway heading south.

As you approach Thorburn Street you will begin a climb that will climax at the top of Mt. Tabor - an elevation gain of about 400 feet in little over a mile. If you head in the general direction of the top of the mountain, you will eventually reach the park entrance at 60th and Yamhill. Run into the park and turn right toward the volcanic crater. Turn left at the crater and follow the roads to the top of the hill and the spectacular view of the city.

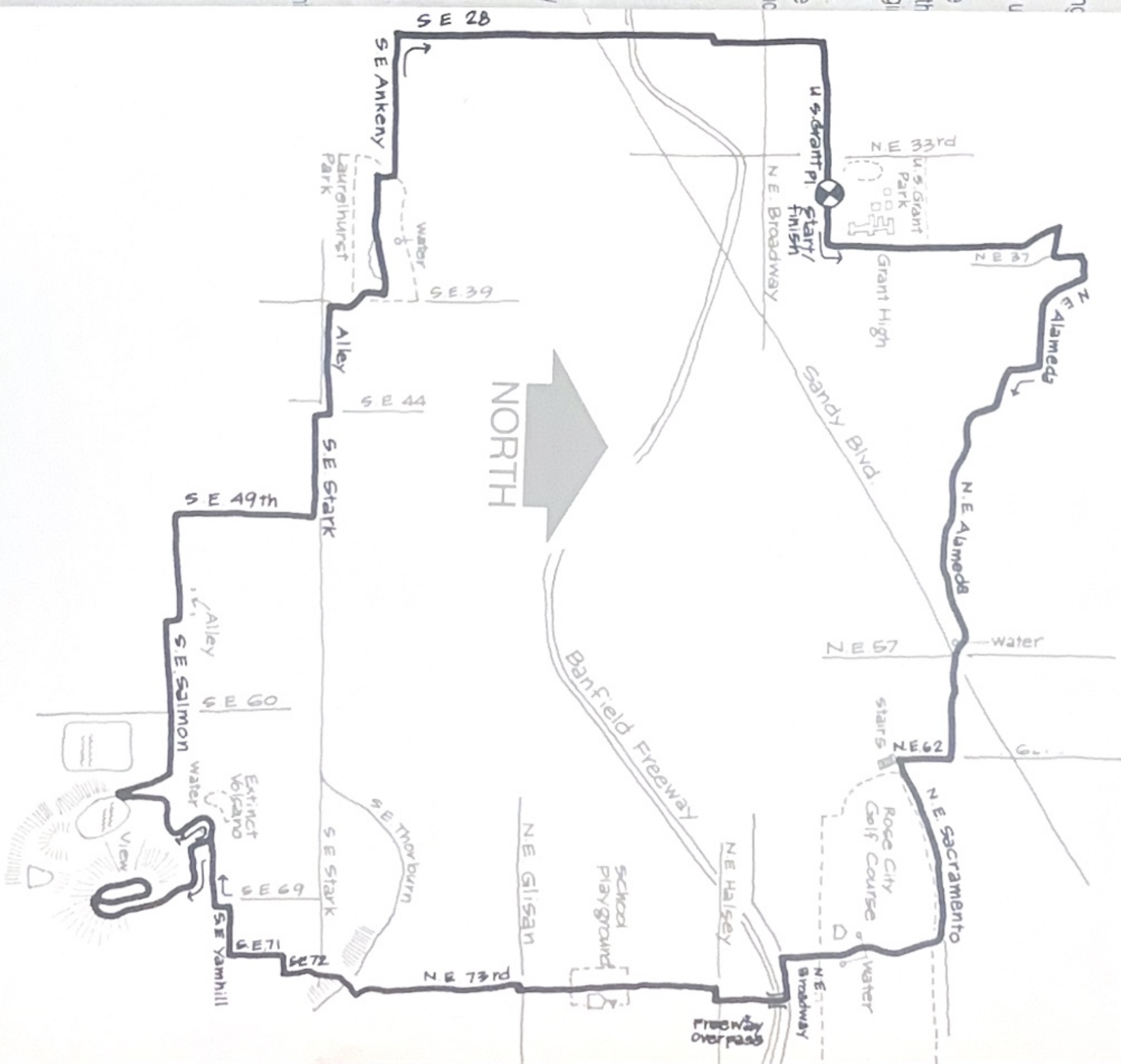
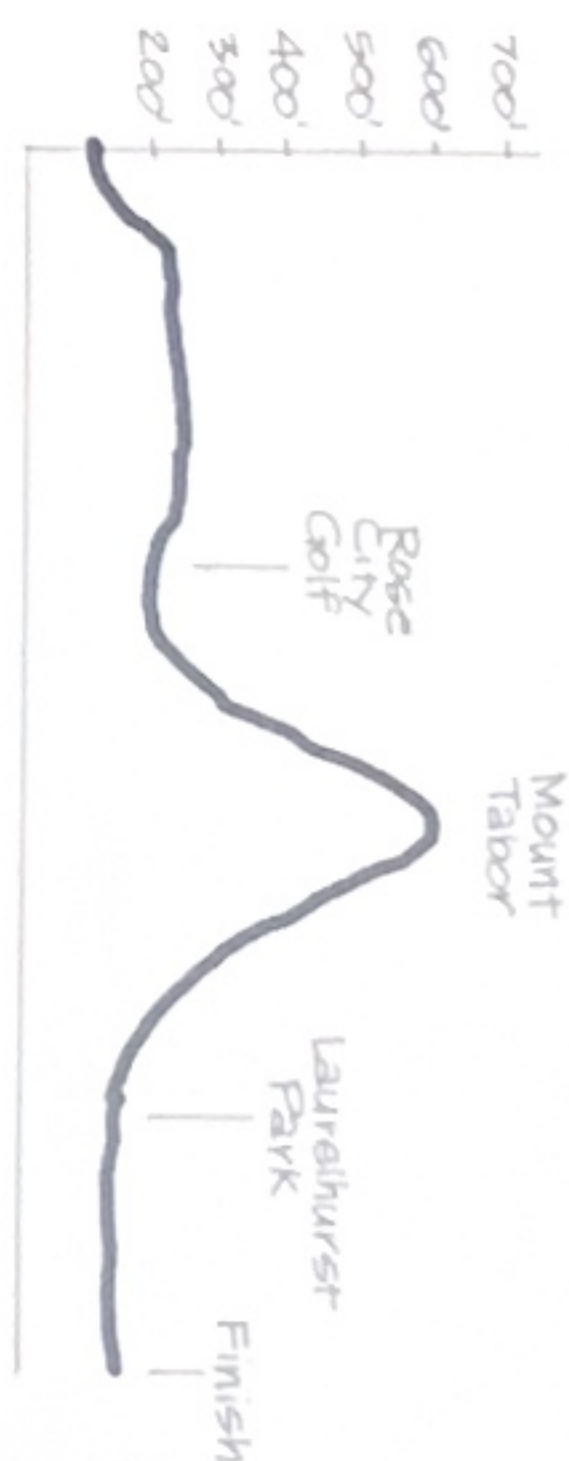
Begin the trip back by retracing your steps downhill to the crater. Turn left and wind down the hill on your trip to Laurelhurst Park. Use the alley shown on the map. It will stop at 39th, across from the park. Run through the park, stopping for water, and emerge at the northwest corner of the park on S.E. Ankeny.

Run west on Ankeny until you reach S.E. 28th. Turn right and run north crossing Glisan, Burnside, Sandy Blvd., the freeway, and N.E. Broadway.

A few blocks north of Broadway make the right turn on N.E. U.S. Grant Place for the final stretch back to Grant Park.

Suggested by: Dean Gisvold

Grant Park/Mt. Tabor Loop
Distance
10.8 mi. (17.4 km.)
Difficulty
8 (most difficult = 10)
Beginning Point
U.S. Grant Park
Conditions
(Best Conditions = 10)
Aesthetics - 10
Bad weather running - 8
Auto traffic - 4
Running Surface
Roads and sidewalks



2

Rocky Butte Loop

Distance

3.2 mi. (5.1km.)

Difficulty

7 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Parking lot at top of Butte

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 8

Bad weather running - 8

Auto traffic - 3

Running Surface

Paved roads

This running route is a "sleeper" – relatively unused by runners, yet offering one of the most picturesque vistas on the entire east side of the city. The run starts and ends on the top of Rocky Butte, so get ready to exercise your quadriceps and lungs for the 300 foot haul from the base back to the summit.

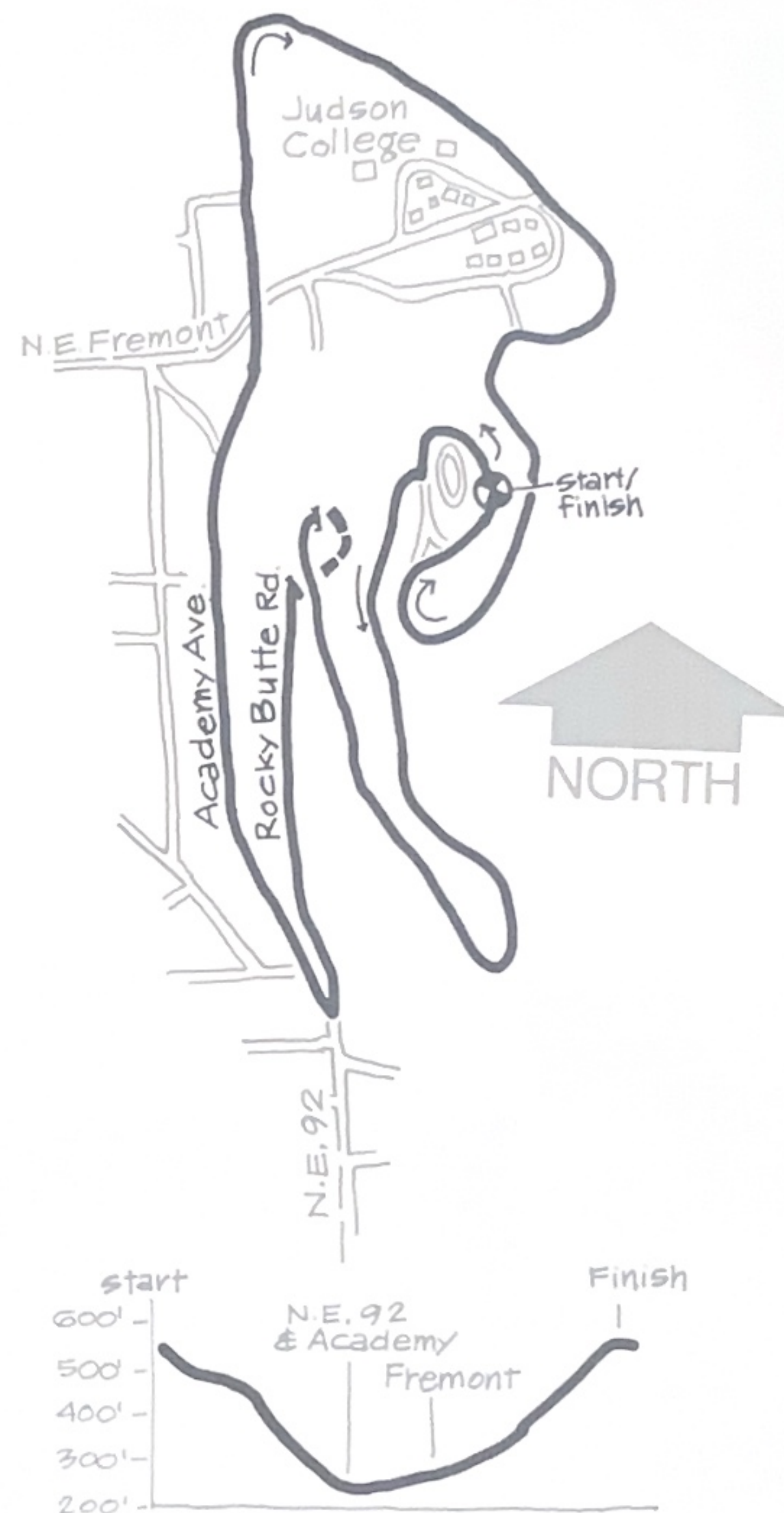
To get to Rocky Butte, use the approach from N.E. 92nd Avenue or the Fremont approach from 82nd Avenue and follow the signs to the top. Once you're on Rocky Butte Road, you'll get there. If you pass the infamous county jail on the east side, go back because you're going the wrong way.

Head out of the parking lot via the road on the west side (facing the city) and follow the road to the bottom of the hill. Turn right on Academy Avenue at the intersection and stay on Academy as it winds around the north side of the Butte past Judson Baptist College (the old Hill Military Academy). Traverse the east slopes above the county jail back to the parking lot on the summit.

Rock climbers often are around the walls on the summit practicing their skills.

There is no water or restrooms.

Suggested by: Paul Christensen



3

Oaks Park Loop

Distance

2.4 mi. (3.8 km.)

Difficulty

2 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

North end, Sellwood Park
S.E. 7th & Malden

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 10

Bad weather running - 8

Auto traffic - 10

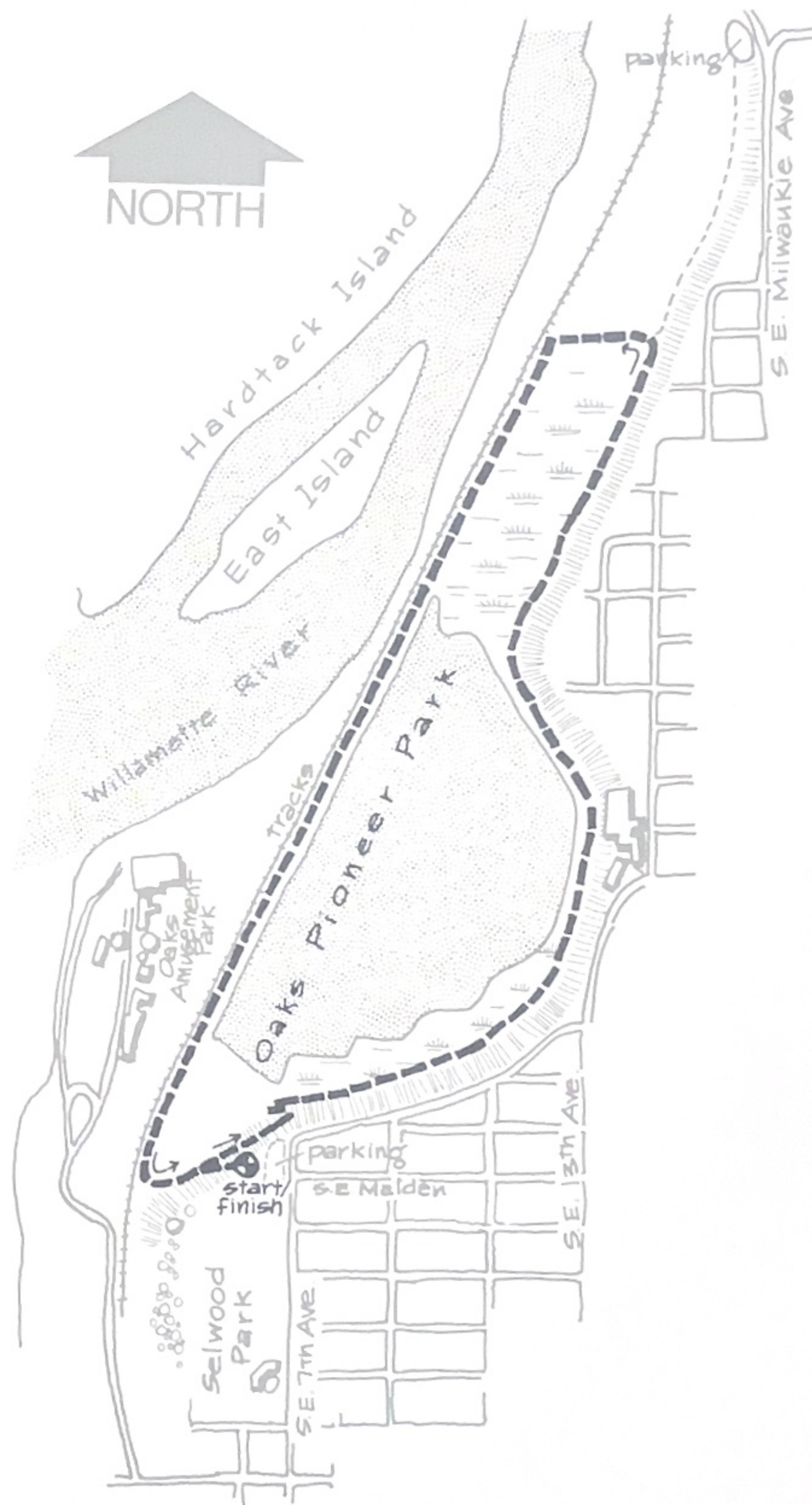
Running Surface

Dirt and wood chip
trail, railroad shoulder

Would you believe it is possible to run through a wildlife sanctuary in a pristine-like setting along the Willamette River in the heart of the city? Before you scoff, try this lovely gem. Do the lower loop 2 or 3 times if you feel energetic, and stay around for a picnic and gay nineties type afternoon with the kids in Oaks Amusement Park.

If you are coming from the west side cross the Sellwood Bridge, go east two blocks and turn left on SE 7th Ave. Drive to Malden Street and park in the Sellwood Park parking lot. Directly west of the parking lot is a cement light pole with a wooden bench beside it. Run to that point, and you'll see the trail dipping suddenly down the cliff at a leftward angle and switchbacking to the swampland below.

Follow the trail to the right going around the Oaks-Pioneer Park, part of the city's Sellwood Park system. Keep following the toe of the slope next to Oaks Bottom Park, a recently established wildlife sanctuary administered by the city in a unique collaboration with the local chapter of the Audubon Society. Take the left fork in the trail and run south along the railroad tracks with good views of the river. Look for the trail that slants up the hill alongside Sellwood Park. Follow it back to the starting point.



4

Reed College/
Eastmoreland Loop

Distance
4.5 mi. (7.3km.)

Difficulty
2 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point
Crystal Springs Rhododendron
Test Gardens parking lot on
S.E. 28th at west end of Reed
College campus

Conditions
(Best Conditions = 10)
Aesthetics - 8
Bad weather running - 9
Auto traffic - 7

Running Surface
Paved road and grass

The Reed College/Eastmoreland Golf Course area is one of the most beautiful and enchanting corners of the city. Yet these virtues are generally missed by the auto passenger.

The starting point can be reached by turning south off S.E. Holgate at 28th or, if you're coming from the south, crossing the Bybee overpass and turning left on 28th.

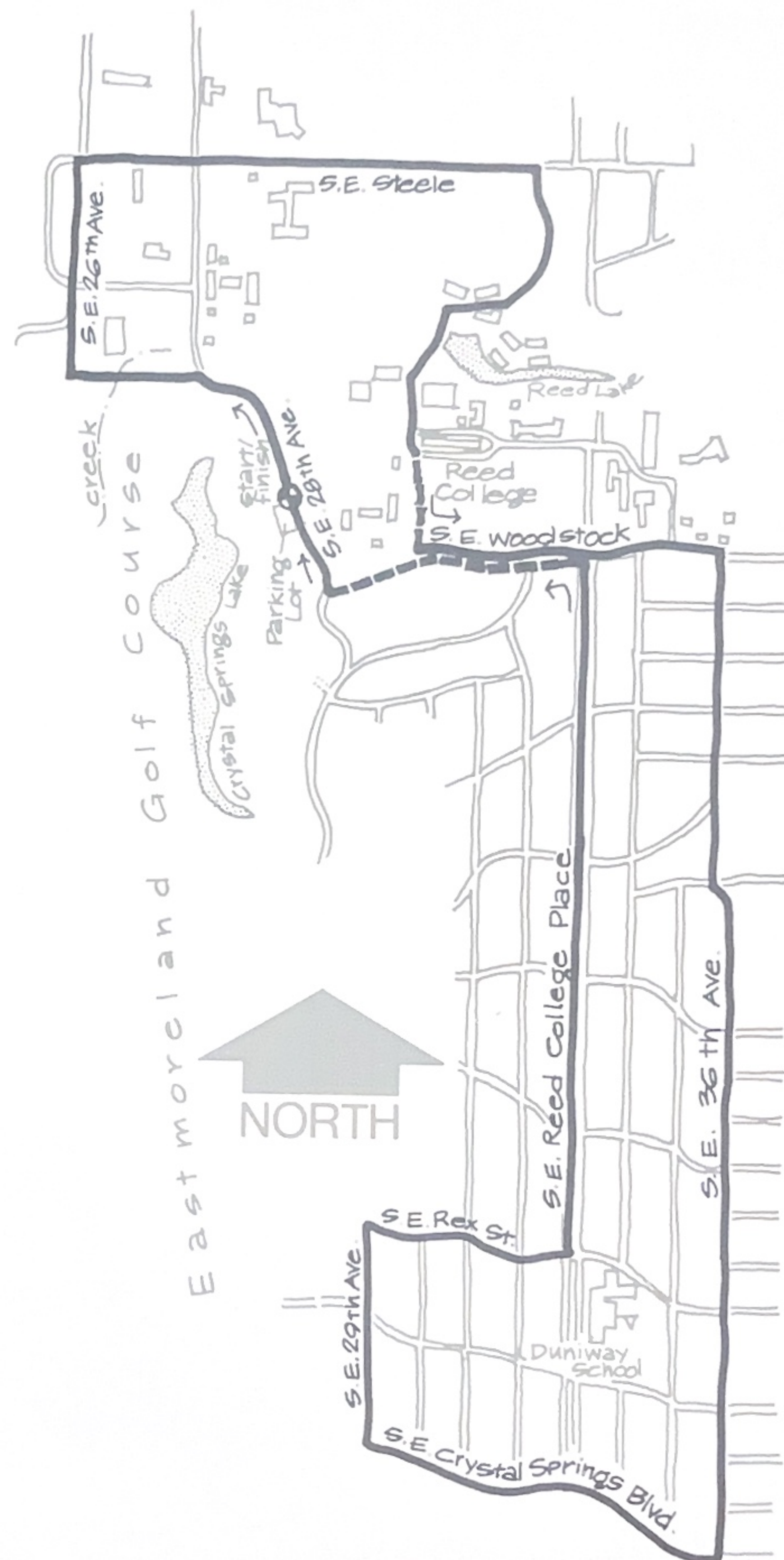
Park in the Rhododendron Society's parking lot. The run starts along S.E. 28th. Follow the paved pathway running north from the parking lot. Turn west at the edge of the golf course and cross a small creek before coming out on S.E. 26th Avenue. Turn right on 26th and right again in two blocks at S.E. Steele Street. Go up the hill, crossing S.E. 28th and continue climbing on Steele.

Just past Eastmoreland General Hospital, you'll come to a large grassy field on the Reed Campus. Run on the grass along Steele another 1/4 mile, turn right at the driveway and follow it to its end at a dormitory complex. At the far end of the parking lot, take one of the asphalt walkways that descends a small hill and meets the dirt road running north/south between the west end of the small lake and the swimming pool. Follow this road south up the hill past the gymnasium on your right. Bear straight ahead across the pavement and the campus to Woodstock Boulevard. Turn left and follow Woodstock up to 36th Avenue. Turn right on 36th into the Eastmoreland neighborhood.

During spring and summer, Eastmoreland streets resemble tunnels, with trees from both sides embracing each other over your head.

Follow 36th through this quiet and charming neighborhood to Crystal Springs Blvd., and turn right. Jog past some of Portland's loveliest homes down to 29th. Turn right, run 2 blocks, and turn right again on S.E. Rex. Follow Rex for four blocks up to Reed College Place. Turn left, and you now have a choice of running on the street or the grassy boulevard straight north nearly a mile to Woodstock and the Reed campus. Go left on Woodstock and run along the campus down the hill, bearing right at 28th back to your car.

Cool off with a drink at the fountain and wind down by taking a walk through the idyllic beauty of the Rhododendron Gardens.



5

University of Portland/ Pier Park Loop

Distance

7.4 mi. (11.8 km.)

Difficulty

5 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

University of Portland
main gate on Willamette
Blvd.

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 4

Bad weather running - 9

Auto traffic - 6

Running Surface

Paved roads, sidewalks,
asphalt and gravel paths

This loop will offer some surprises for runners unfamiliar with North Portland. It is a primarily sidewalk and city street route that links the forested trails in Pier Park with the University of Portland and views of the Willamette River. Parts of this course lie along the route of the Portland Marathon.

The run begins at the entrance to the campus, by the sign on the north side of the driveway. There is parking on the campus and on Willamette Blvd. For the easiest access to the campus from I-5 (going north), take the Portland Blvd. exit, drive west to Willamette Blvd., and follow it to the campus.

Run north on the sidewalk at the edge of the campus to Portsmouth Avenue. Cross Willamette at the light, following Portsmouth north to Fessenden, and turn left. You'll be on sidewalks the whole way. Shortly past the point where Fessenden bends left, turn right at Pier Park Place. Follow it to the end and pick up the gravel trail in the park.

Follow the path, staying right along the eastern perimeter of the park, climbing the small hill and descending the ridge in the trees. Take the sharp left at the fork and head back into the park. Turn right at the asphalt trail by the wading pool. Run on the asphalt path to the woodshed on your left and veer sharp left, coming out on James Street. Turn left on James, follow it to the corner, and go right on St. Johns Street by the pool. There'll be unusual views of the river as you follow Willamette Blvd. under the St. Johns Bridge and back to the University. There are restrooms and water in Pier Park in season. Suggested by: Helmut Becker



6

Delta Park Dash

Distance

4.9 mi. (7.8 km.)

Difficulty

3 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Field house in East Park

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 5

Bad weather running - 10

Auto traffic - 9

Running Surface

Paved roads and grass

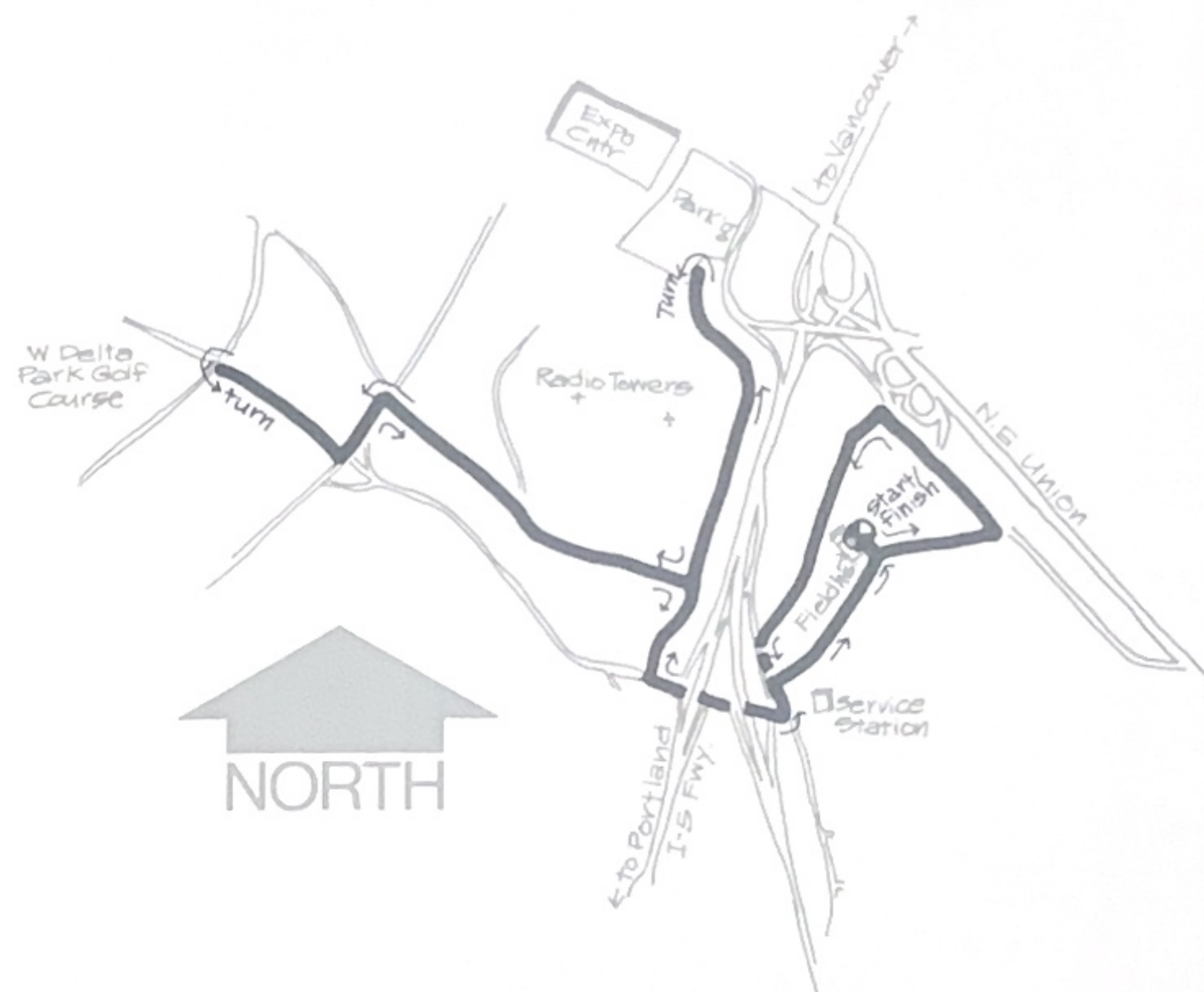
Delta is a large city park located on the Columbia River flatlands straddling I-5 north of Portland near Portland Meadows race track. It's a great running and jogging place with plenty of wide roads, spacious grassy areas, and relatively little traffic. The flatness of the area appeals to many runners, and the 18.6 mile Oregon Roadrunner race over this same course in early February is a popular training run for the Seaside Marathon.

Take the Delta Park Exit off I-5 and drive to the park headquarters/field house in the East Park. The run starts by the yellow phone booth. Run 50 yards to the STOP sign and go left between the athletic fields.

As you come back by the field house on North Marine Way, keep going straight another ¼ mile or so to the road's end at the turn-around. Take the path leading south across the grass from the circle, picking up the road again by the STOP sign near the service station. Take a right and go under the freeway, up the small hill and right towards the Exposition Center. Turn around at the entrance to the Center's parking lot by the NO PARKING IN THIS BLOCK sign and retrace your steps.

Turn right at the first intersection, heading west along the slough. Turn left at the STOP sign by the fence and then turn right at the golf course sign. Follow the road to the golf course entrance gate, turn around, and retrace your steps back out to the second STOP sign. Turn right and stay on the road back to the field house.

There are restrooms and water at the building in season.



7

Laurelhurst Park

Distance

Outside Loop - .82 mi. (1.3 km.)
Figure Eight Loop - .86 mi.
(1.4 km.)

Difficulty

1 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

By restrooms on S.E. Ankeny
Laurelhurst Park

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)
Aesthetics - 7
Bad weather running - 10
Auto traffic - 10

Running Surface

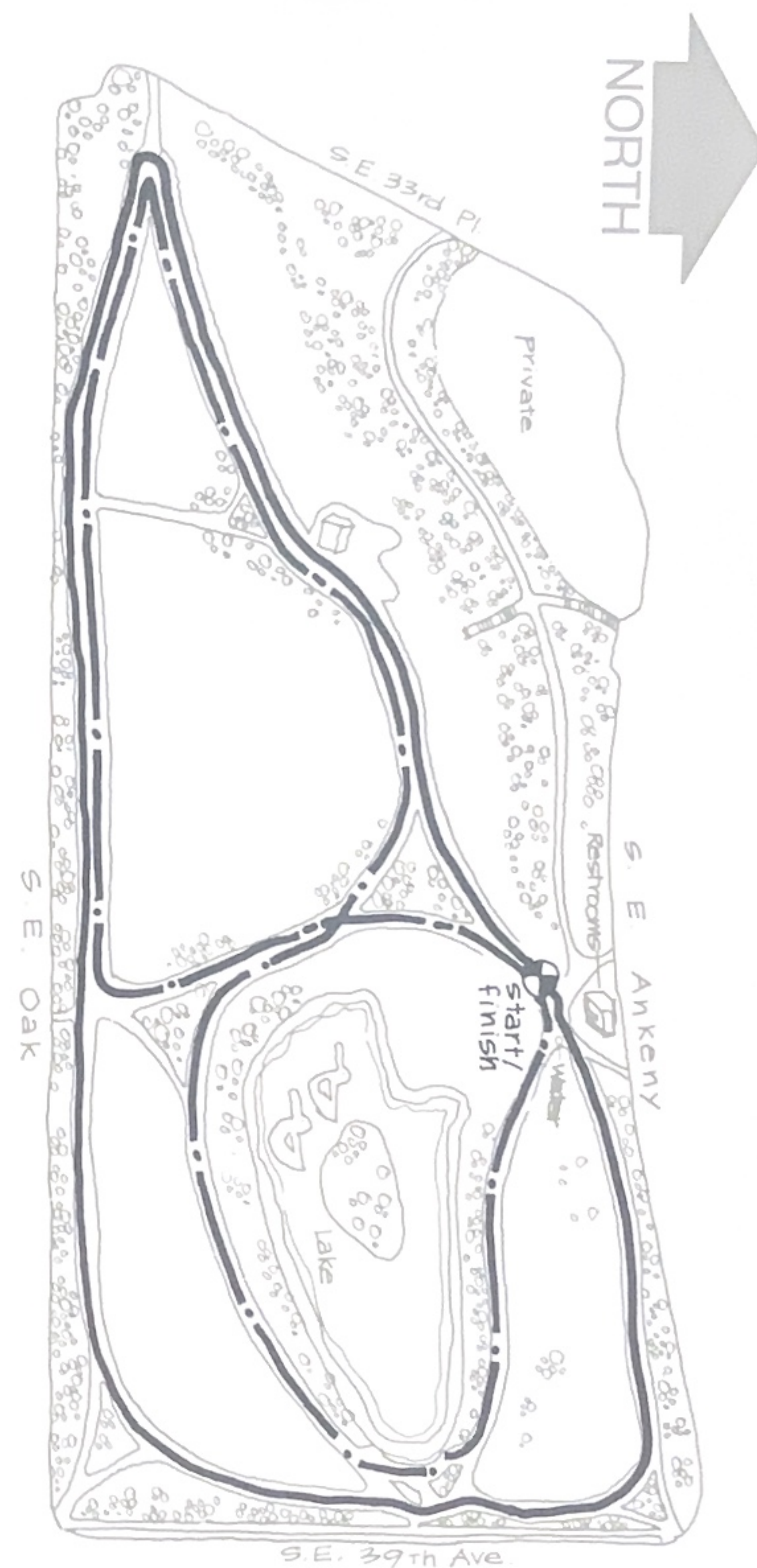
Paved paths

Laurelhurst Park sits right in the heart of the east side residential area and in nice weather is alive with joggers, strollers, sitters, and elderly citizens feeding ducks and swans. Easy access is assured by the park's location a block south of East Burnside. Park along Ankeny and enter along either of the walkways on that street.

Run these loops either way and as many times as feels right. If you still feel energetic, venture out and jog around some of the local neighborhoods. On summer week-end days, enjoy a concert while you're doing your stretches on the grassy field along Oak Street.



Figure 8 Run
Outside Loop



Suburban East Side



8

Troutdale Trot

Distance

6.8 mi. (10.8 km.)

Difficulty

7 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Troutdale City Park on the Sandy River

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 7

Bad weather running - 10

Auto traffic - 5

Running Surface

Paved roads

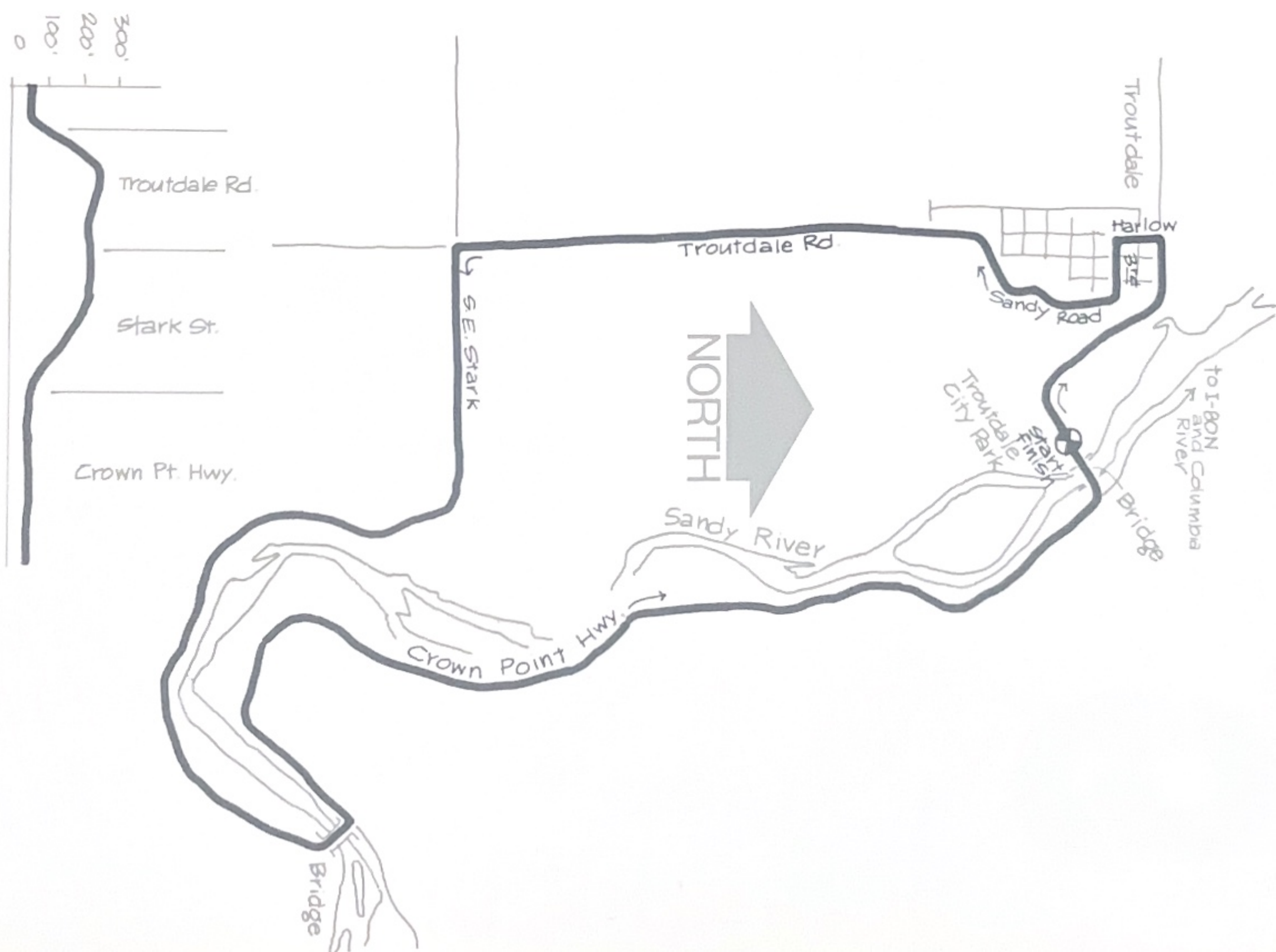
This loop (the course of an annual May road run) offers a quickly accessible, rustic diversion to city-dwelling runners with its fine sampling of the Sandy River Gorge. If the city blues and smog are getting you down, this anecdote of clean air, tall trees and rushing waters might be just the ticket.

Drive east on the Banfield Freeway (I-80 N) and watch for Troutdale signs. Follow them into the town, then continue through the business district and down the hill toward the river. Turn right into the city parking lot just before you reach the bridge.

Start your run at the parking lot. Turn left and head up the hill back into town, turning left at the second street (Harlow). Go up Harlow two blocks and left again on 3rd St. Continue to climb as 3rd winds around the front of the hill overlooking the river and turns into Sandy Road. In another half-mile or so, Sandy Road becomes Troutdale Road.

Follow Troutdale Road to its intersection with Stark Street, turn left and begin your descent to the river. Continue on Stark to the first bridge and cross over to the Crown Point Highway. Bear left back along the other side of the river.

The highway is narrow but has good running shoulders on both sides. Cross at the next bridge and head back to the park. There are picnic tables, restrooms and water in the park in season. If the sun is out and you want an instant refresher, take a dip in the river — but no fair testing the water first!



9

Mount Hood Community College Loop

Distance

6.2 mi. (10 km.)

Difficulty

6 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Mt. Hood Community
College entrance on N.E.
17th Dr., Gresham, Ore.

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 7

Bad weather running - 9

Auto traffic - 4

Running Surface

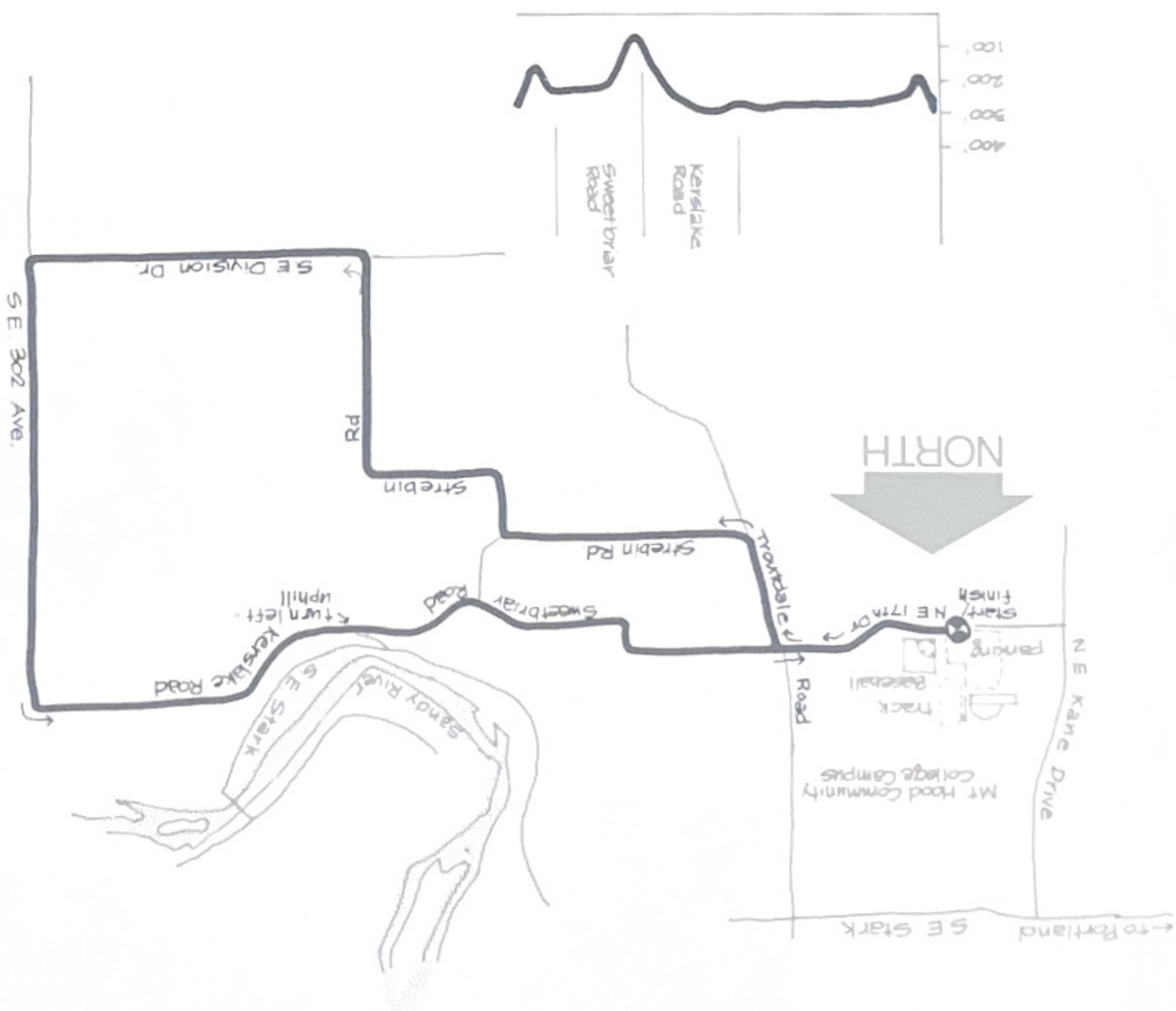
Paved roads

This beautiful loop, the scene of the annual Fred Meyer Run, offers a scenic tour of the least-known corner of Multnomah County. Drive out the Banfield and take the Wood Village exit to Stark St. Turn left on Stark to N.E. Kane Dr. and turn right at the college. Stay on Kane, going past the college and turn left on N.E. 17th. Take the second driveway on your left into the college parking lot.

Start running east from the driveway past the N.E. LaMesa Pl. street sign, going downhill to the creek and up the the STOP sign at Troutdale Road. Now you can start enjoying the country air. Run right on Troutdale Rd. to the first intersection, then go left (don't hunt for a sign as it's unmarked). Follow this road (Strebini) east through open farm land with the Corbett/Springdale area looming to your left across the Sandy River canyon and Larch Mountain further right on that same ridge.

Turn right at the first fork, and follow the road past the dilapidated red barn on your right, coming out on S.E. Division Drive. Go left, running along good shoulders on the road to 302nd and turn left again, heading back into farming country. Pass a tree farm you'll begin the descent into the Sand canyon. Take Sweetbriar Road, which angles up left a couple hundred yards past the dead-end road, also on your left. Follow Sweetbriar over the top of the hill straight past the housing development on your right to Troutdale Road and back to the starting point.

Suggested by: Sid Christie



10

Corbett High Loop

Distance

5.8 mi. (9.3 km.)

Difficulty

6 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Corbett High School

Conditions

(Best conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 8

Bad weather running - 9

Auto traffic - 8

Running Surface

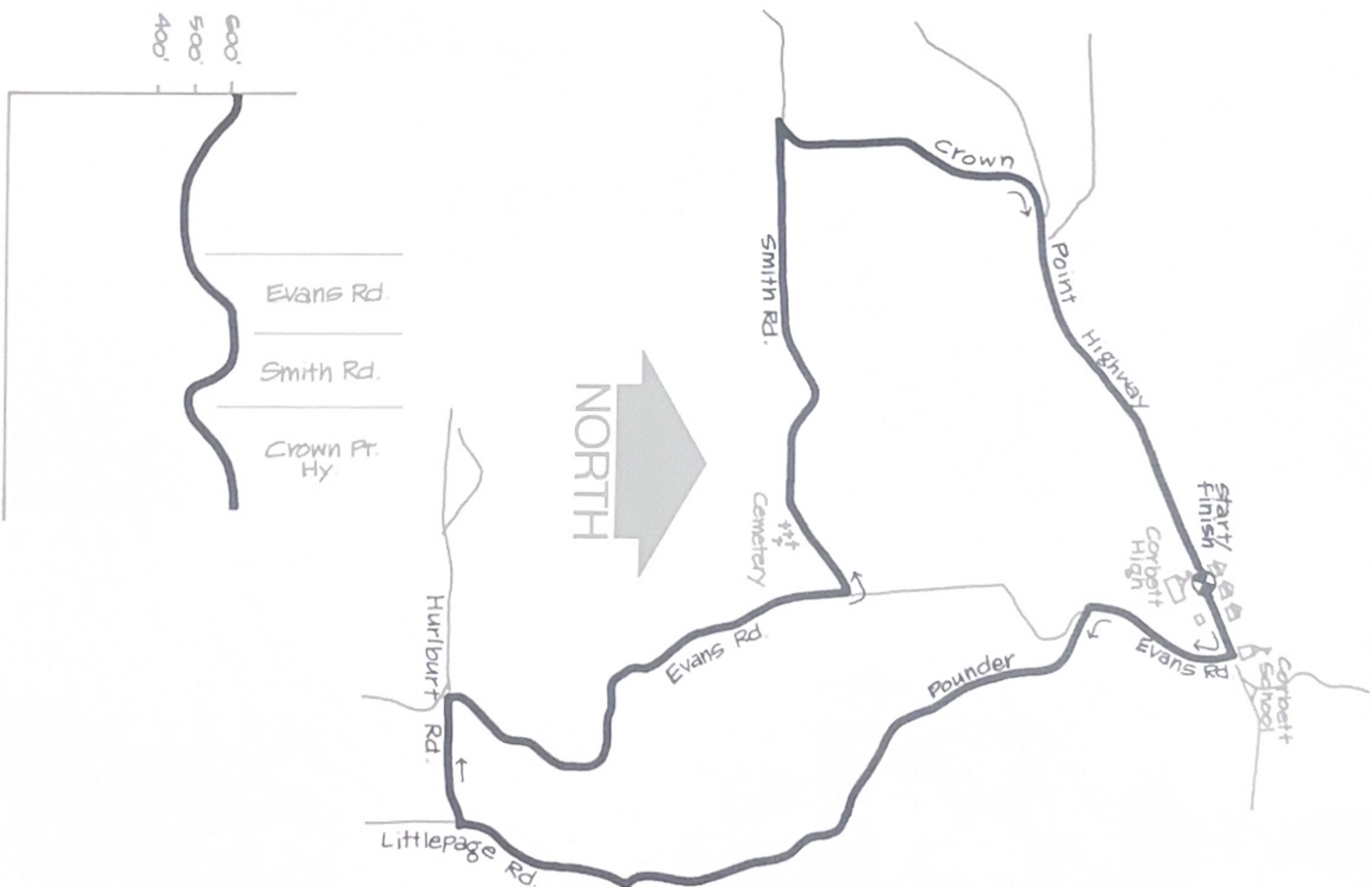
Paved road

If you like the outdoors and aren't too familiar with the spectacular Columbia Gorge/Crown Point country, head for Corbett, weather permitting. The latter is important as the winds on top of the ridge can be very strong and in cold weather, outright nasty.

Drive out the Banfield Freeway along the Columbia River toward Multnomah Falls and take the Corbett Exit. Now you're in lower Corbett, but you aren't there yet! Follow the signs going straight up the mountain and be thankful you aren't running it. Turn right at the top, drive to the high school on your left and park there.

You're on top of the ridge looking south over farms and forest to the Sandy River canyon. Run about a block north and start down Evans Road. Take it easy and enjoy yourself, remembering what goes down, must come up.

Littlepage, Hurlburt and Evans Roads all give you with stop signs and as you rejoin Evans, you begin to climb again. This countryside, and the homes and farms sprinkled over it, has a haunting dreamlike quality to it. It's not true that geography is a "dead" quality. Some places "live" and emanate their own particular vibrations - this is one of them. There's mystery in the air here, but don't let this scare you away.



II

Glendoveer

Distance

1.8 mi. (2.9 km.)

Difficulty

1 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Beginning of path on Glisan by parking lot

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 5

Bad weather running - 9

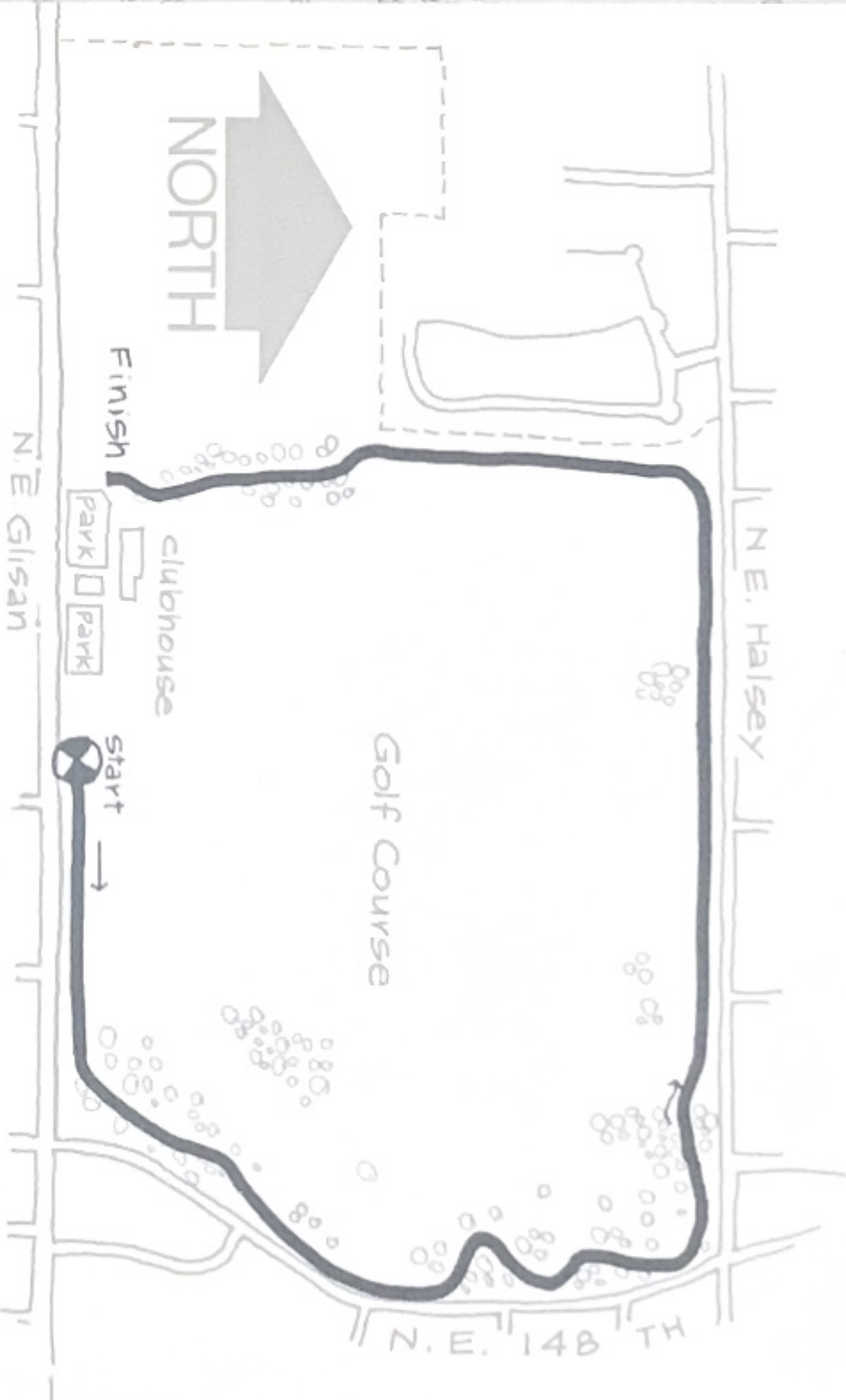
Auto traffic - 10

Running Surface

Wood chip trail

The Glendoveer loop is the only one in this book that was built exclusively for running. Multnomah County added this trail to its Glendoveer Golf Course – an idea that could be repeated in a number of Portland golf courses. In addition to the running, you can take part in the 10 "Vita" exercises that occur at different points along the trail. These consist of doing chin-ups, sit-ups, push-ups, etc., and will probably be seen by many runners as an unnecessary interruption to an otherwise lovely run. Whether or not you are interested in "Vita" exercises, give Glendoveer a try. The course winds through some beautiful wooded areas and the soft wood-chip trail is a welcome relief to feet used to pounding hard pavement.

Glendoveer can be reached by traveling east on NE Glisan from 122nd. Look for the start of the trail about 1/4 mile to the right of the clubhouse. Water and restrooms are available at the clubhouse. Suggested by Pam Melvin



New Era Loop

Distance

5.3 mi. (8.5 km.)

Difficulty

3 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Warner Grange Hall,

New Era, Ore.

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 7

Bad weather running - 10

Auto traffic - 7

Running Surface

Paved roads

The Canby-New Era area south of Oregon City is steeped in some of the northwest's most interesting history. The New Era/Spiritualist Church history is one of the least-known aspects of this area's past. This loop winds around the farm land east of New Era and Canby, past old farm homes and rustic barns.

Driving south from Oregon City on Highway 99 watch for the WARNER GRANGE - CAMP NEW ERA CENTRAL POINT sign on your right as you go up a long hill. Take the first sharp turn to the left at the top of the hill and park in the grange hall lot a few yards down the road.

From the lot, turn right and run north, past an ancient farm and buildings on your left. Next, you'll pass the camp grounds of the New Era Spiritualist Church on your right, still in use after more than 100 years at that location. Follow the road down the hill and across the bridge over Beaver Creek.

At about the 1 1/2 mile point, turn right at the Central Point Road sign. Run along the base of the hill and down into farms again to the first intersection. Turn right there (Brammer Road, but the sign is down) and continue west through the rolling hills. You'll know you're on the right path when you pass the Triple H Charolais Ranch at the top of the last hill.

Turn right at the next STOP (Haines Road, but again, no sign) and follow this wider road with good shoulders to its junction with Hwy. 99 just past the orchard. Run about 200 yards along the bike lane of the highway, and you'll come back to the NEW ERA turn off, with the grange just up the road



Near West Side



Tryon Creek Rim Trail/Center Loops

Distance

Rim Trail - 2.9 mi.

(4.7 km.)

Center Loop - .57 mi.

(.91 km.)

Beginning Point

Nature House at Park
Entrance

Difficulty

(Most difficult = 10)

Rim Trail - 2

Center Loop - 1

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 10

Bad weather running - 5

Auto traffic - 10

Running Surface

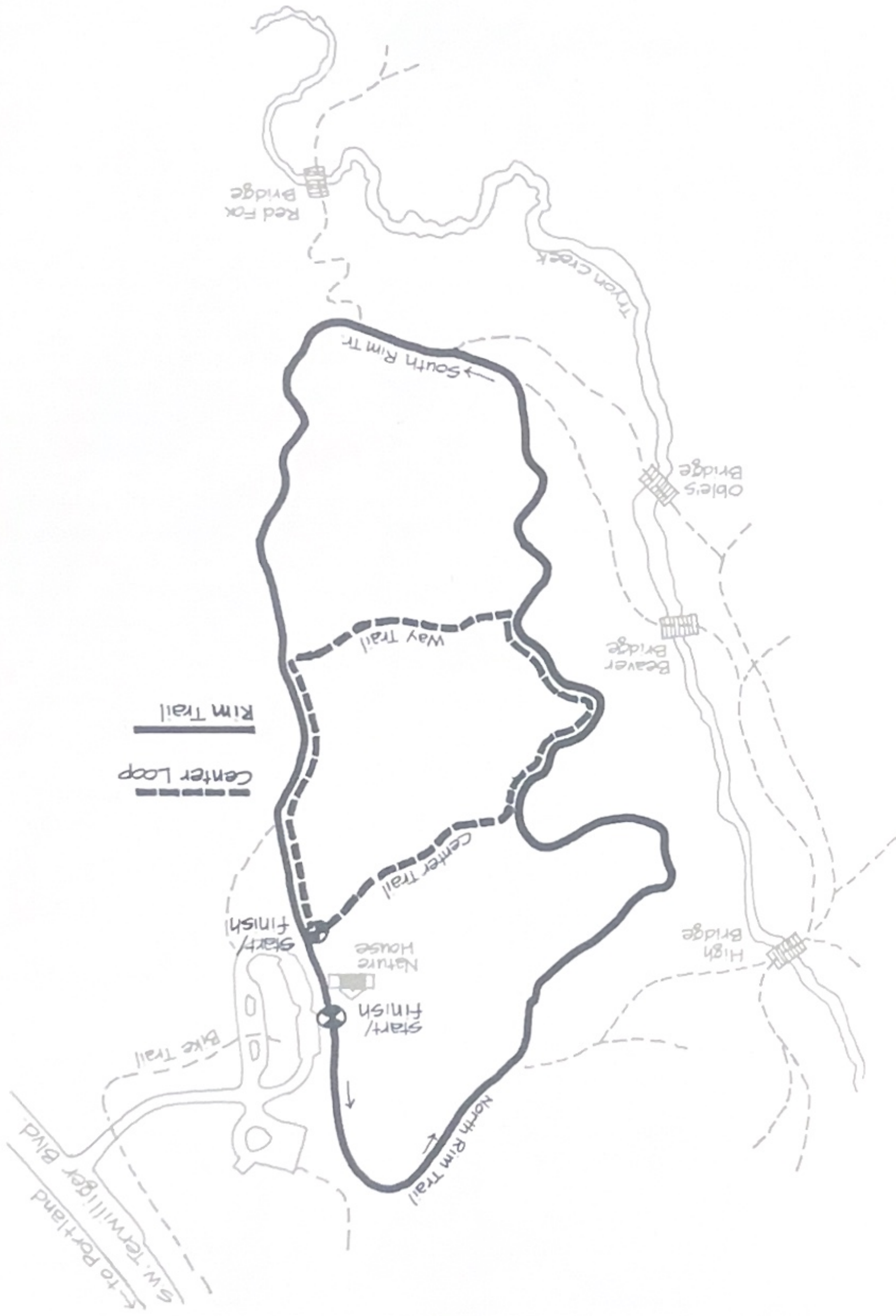
Dirt Trails

One of the most impressive recent environmental victories locally was the creation of Tryon Creek State park in 1975, an action originally by a group of local citizens intent on preserving this area as a wilderness sanctuary. This lovely forested park straddles Tryon Creek and shelters its passage through the swampy bottomlands as it runs from Boones Ferry Road near the Lewis and Clark Law School on the west down to State Street and Lake Oswego on the eastern border.

Drive south on Terwilliger from where it crosses I-5 and head toward the Lewis and Clark campus. Bear left at the Boones Ferry Road intersection staying on Terwilliger to the park entrance on your right (about 1/4 mile past the Law School).

Both of these short loops stay on high ground and offer nice views of the bottomlands below. Start at the Nature House. For the Center Loop, jog a few yards east of the Nature House and you'll see the Center Trail heading off right. The Nature Center has displays and helpful information about the abundant flora and fauna indigenous to the Park and is open every day during most of the year.

Restrooms and a drinking fountain are available at the Center. Suggested by: Judy Burger



Tryon Creek Horse Loop

Distance

3 mi. (4.8 km.)

Difficulty

3 (Most difficult = 10)

Beginning Point

Equestrian Area west of parking lot

Conditions

(Best Conditions = 10)

Aesthetics - 10

Bad weather running - 2

Auto traffic - 10

Running Surface

Dirt trails

This fine loop gives you a tour of some of the highlights in this wilderness park. Directions to the park are given under the other Tryon Creek Run immediately preceding this. The run starts from the Equestrian area. Turn right off the entrance drive before you reach the Nature House. Heading west on the trail from the parking area, stay right at the first fork and do the loop in a figure eight, bearing left after crossing the bridge in the canyon. You'll be descending about 125 feet to the creek and climbing again each time you cross. The creek area is especially enchanting, with miniature swamps, sandy bars, huge decaying logs and abundant swamp flowers. The bottomlands can become very slippery after heavy rains, sometimes completely inundated, so watch the weather. This loop is a horse loop (the only horse trail in the park) and you're likely to encounter one anytime. When you do, slow down and move to the side of the trail so as not to startle the horses.

